secretary of state Warren Christopher the famous “deposit” in which he defined—conditionally and hypothetically—Israel’s conditions for a future settlement with Syria and the Israeli willingness to withdraw from the Golan Heights.[2] Assad refrained from responding substantively to the “deposit,” sticking to his precondition that Israel commit to withdrawing from the entire Golan Heights. Rabin, who did not want to give up on the Syrian track so easily, sent me to ask King Hassan II of Morocco to check directly with President Assad if he was serious about the peace process and what he would be willing to give in exchange for an Israeli withdrawal from the Golan Heights. The answers that the Moroccan king returned with did not satisfy Rabin’s minimum conditions, and the process failed.

Rabin also assessed that the Oslo process, which was taking place simultaneously, secretly and completely independently from King Hussein, could make progress on the negotiations with Jordan difficult. When the Oslo signing ceremony was decided upon in Washington, Rabin did not even intend to participate, and he did so only under pressure from President Clinton. I remember a meeting between Rabin and King Hussein on the eve of the signing of the agreement, held at the king’s palace in Amman. At the end of the meeting, after they had finished discussing all the issues, the king turned to Rabin with a sarcastic smile and said, “I understand that you are going to Washington for the signing ceremony of the Oslo agreement.” When Rabin nodded, the king added, “Until now I’m the one who has had to suffer Arafat’s wet kisses—now it’s your turn!”

Yitzhak and I did not have the chance to analyze the Oslo affair together, but in my opinion, over time, during Yitzhak’s second term as prime minister, he became convinced that the State of Israel could not continue to live by the sword and that no opportunity to break through the wall of hostility should be neglected. This is the logical explanation for his conduct in the three tracks: the Palestinian, in a completely passive manner until it ripened; the Jordanian, in a very active way throughout, until the signing of the peace treaty; and the Syrian, which he managed directly until it failed.

In my opinion, the Israeli-Jordanian peace agreement was the peak of Yitzhak’s achievements and his greatest contribution to the resolution of the historical Arab-Israeli conflict. What a pity that he did not receive the Nobel Peace Prize for this accomplishment. After his murder, we set up a commemorative corner in Yitzhak’s honor in the lobby of the Mossad